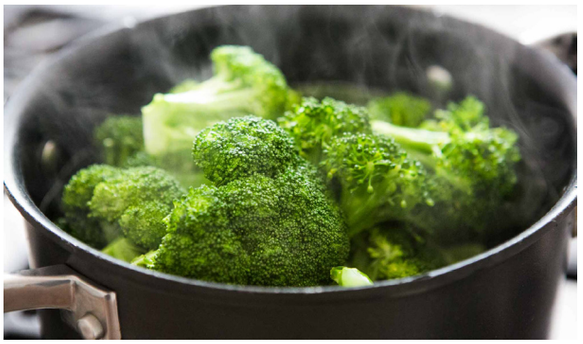
3. Steaming:

It is a method of cooking food in steam generated vigorously from boiling water in a pan. The food to be steamed is placed in a container and is not in direct contact with the water or liquid. Idli, custard and idiappam are made by steaming. Vegetables can also be steamed.



Advantages

- Steaming shortens the duration of cooking and helps to conserve nutritive value, colour, flavour and palatability of food.
- Steamed food is light, nutritious and easy to digest. Such foods are good, especially for people who are sick or people with weak digestion or for the elderly. Young children can be served with steamed food.

Disadvantages

- Steaming equipment is required.
- This method is limited to the preparation of selected foods.

4. Pressure cooking :

When steam under pressure is used, the method is known as **"Pressure cooking"** and the equipment used is the pressure cooker. In this method the temperature of boiling water can be raised above 100 ^{0}C. Rice, meat, roots and tubers are usually pressure cooked.



Advantages

- Pressure cooking kills all bacteria and hence the food is safe and hygienic to eat.
- The food gets cooked faster i.e. almost 1/3rd time than boiling.
- Saves fuel, time and energy.
- Several foods can be cooked together in the pressure cooker by using separators.
- It is not necessary to immerse food in water while cooking and this reduces the loss of water soluble vitamins and minerals.

Disadvantages

- If food is cooked for very long, it loses its texture and may even burn.
- Knowledge of the usage, care and maintenance of cooker is required to prevent accidents.
- Careful watch on the cooking time is required to prevent over cooking.

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